

PARISH SCHEDULE

DATE	ST MARY STAR OF THE SEA	ST JOSEPH'S
Mon 28	10am: MASS 10am-7pm: Private Prayer	10am-7pm: Private Prayer
Tue 29	10am-7pm: Private Prayer 7pm: NOVENA MASS	10am-7pm: Private Prayer
Wed 30	10am-7pm: Private Prayer	10am: MASS NO ADORATION TODAY
Thu 1	10am-7pm: Private Prayer	12noon-7pm: Private Prayer 7pm: Evening Prayer
Fri 2	10am-7pm: Private Prayer	10am: FIRST FRIDAY MASS 7-8pm: HOLY HOUR
Sat 3	4.15pm: Confessions 5.00pm: VIGIL MASS	10.00am: MASS & Confessions 10am-7pm: Private Prayer
Sun 4	10am-7pm: Private Prayer	10am MASS 11am-7pm: Private Prayer

MASS INTENTIONS

Mon 28: Priest's Intention
 Tue 29: Bella Caldwell
 Wed 30: Priest's Intention
 Fri 2: For the Holy Souls
 Sat 3 (10am): For the Parish
 Sat 3 (5pm): Priest's Intentions
 Sun 4: Damian Fitzgerald



Mass Intention Envelopes are available in the Churches and can be left in Offertory baskets during Mass, the Parish Office or directly with Fr Robert.

REST IN PEACE

RECENTLY DECEASED: Kevin McGlennon
 MONTHS MIND: Ita Bell
 ANNIVERSARIES: Jean Byers, Stephen Bell, Betty Smith, Sadie McCarthy, Rachel Arthurs, Ann Ritchie, Geraldine McVeigh, Harry McGrattan, Davy & Kathleen Bell, Merta Watson

Eternal rest grant unto them, O Lord!

This week's Sanctuary Candle will burn for:

St Joseph's: For our Parish
St Mary Star of the Sea: For all Irish Missionaries

Sanctuary candle intentions are requested through the Office.
 A suggested offering of £5.

St Joseph's Church 150th Anniversary

Please note our 150th Anniversary Celebrations, to which all are welcome:

Thursday 1st October - FLORAL EXHIBITION. Feast of St Thérèse of Lisieux. Floral Exhibition will open at 12noon with the Angelus, concluding with Evening Prayer at 7 pm.

Friday 2nd October - FIRST FRIDAY MASS WITH BISHOP ALAN. Feast of the Guardian Angels. Bishop Alan McGuckian will join us for our First Friday Mass at 10 am. Pupils from St Mary's PS will also join us. First Friday Holy Hour from 7-8 pm.

Saturday 3rd October - CELEBRATORY LUNCH at 1.30 pm at Kirkistown Castle Golf Club (Please register at the Parish Office).

Sunday 4th October - HARVEST MASS. 800th Anniversary of St Francis of Assisi: Harvest Mass followed by refreshments and a Farm Animals display for the kids and the young at heart outside the Parochial House.

Wednesday 7th October - FAMILY ROSARY & 24hrs FOR THE LORD. Family Rosary at 7 pm followed by 24 hours of Adoration for the Lord in thanksgiving for 150 years of worship at St Joseph's.

Thursday 8th October - CLOSE OF 24hrs FOR THE LORD. Evening Prayer & Solemn Benediction at 7 pm with Fr John Brown CSSp.

SAINTS OF THE WEEK

Tue 29: Ss Michael, Gabriel and Raphael, Archangels
 Wed 30: St Jerome, Priest, Doctor
 Thu 1: St Thérèse of the Child Jesus, Virgin, Doctor
 Fri 2: The Guardian Angels

"Perfect love means putting up with other people's shortcomings, feeling no surprise at their weaknesses, finding encouragement even in the slightest evidence of good qualities in them."

-St Thérèse of Lisieux (1873-1897)



PARISH NEWS AND EVENTS

WEEKLY OFFERING: The Weekly Offering on last Sunday amounted to £1,440. Thank you for your continued generosity and support.

ST VINCENT DE PAUL: Thank you for your continuing support of the work of SVP. Last week's collection amounted to £260. If you require assistance then please call our confidential helpline number: 07895835215.

ST MARY'S LITTLE STARS Parent/Grandparent, Baby and Toddler Group, a new parish initiative, will meet again on **Thursday 1st October from 10.30am-12.30pm** at the Nunsquarter Room, St Mary Star of the Sea Church. All parents and grandparents with babies and toddlers are welcome to meet, chat, play, and make new friends. For more information, contact Siobhan McAree or Lucy Watson, or the Parish Office.

VOLUNTEERS NEEDED - CHILDREN'S LITURGY GROUP We are looking for volunteers to join our Children's Liturgy Group and help us provide a welcoming and meaningful Liturgy of the Word for our younger members during Mass. If you would be interested in getting involved, or would like to find out more, please **contact the Parish Office**.

24HRS FOR THE LORD: during our week of celebrations for the 150th Anniversary of St Joseph's, there will be a 24hr period of adoration in thanksgiving, **Wednesday 7th at 7pm to Thursday 8th at 7pm**. Parishioners are kindly requested to sign up for an hour or more during the 24hr period. Sign-up sheets are available at the back of the Church.

FROM HEAD TO HEART - a journey through Luke's Gospel. How well do you know the stories of Jesus? This autumn, our parish is offering a unique 8-week introduction to Luke's Gospel presented by Orla McCarthy. Together, we will trace the narrative backwards—from the joy of the empty tomb, through the life and ministry of Jesus, to the stable in Bethlehem as Advent begins. This course will give you the historical context to understand the text, insights to love the stories, and the spiritual tools to turn scripture reading into deep personal prayer. No prior Bible study experience needed! The course commences on **Sunday, 11th October, 7.45-8.45 pm** (after the 7 pm Solemn Rosary) in the Nunsquarter Room, St Mary Star of the Sea.

OUR LADY'S ROSARY FESTIVAL will take place from **12th to 18th October 2026**. Join us for a week of events to honour Our Blessed Lady, ending with the annual Belfast Rosary Procession. The procession will leave St Malachy's Church, Belfast City Centre, at 2.30pm on Sunday 18th October, and finish at St Peter's Cathedral. A full list of events can be found on the poster at the back of the Church and online at belfastrosaryfestival.com

BALLYCRAN GAA LOTTO RESULTS 20th September: No jackpot winner. Next week's jackpot is £3,200. Draw winners: Paddy Dorrian, Douglas Long, Leanne Dunlop.



ALTAR SERVERS: There will be a meeting of Altar Servers on **Monday 28th September at 7.00 pm** in the Nunsquarter Room at St Mary Star of the Sea. Anyone interested in becoming an altar server should contact the Parish Office or Grainne McNamara for an Application Form. It is open to children who have made their First Holy Communion. Training will be provided, and new teams will be established.



POPE'S INTENTION FOR OCTOBER 2026

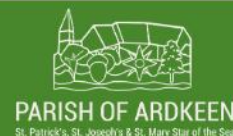
For mental health ministry - Let us pray that the mental health ministry be established throughout the Church, helping to overcome the stigma and discrimination of persons with mental illnesses.

Upcoming Parish Committee Meetings

Finance Committee: 29th September at 7.30pm
Liturgy Committee: 6th October at 7.30pm



Parish Priest: Very Rev Robert Sloan PP VF
Parish Office Tel: 028 42738294 (Parish Support Officer: Mairead)
Parish Office Hours: Monday 9am-4pm, Tuesday 1.30-4pm, Wednesday 9am-3pm, Thursday 9am-4pm, Friday Closed.
Address: 46 Blackstaff Road, Ballycranbeg, Kircubbin, BT22 1AG



Our Vision:

A vibrant and welcoming Catholic Parish witnessing Christian prayerfulness and joyful service in the broader Community.



For more information please see:

Website: www.parishofardkeen.co.uk

Facebook: Parish of Ardkeen